

ART

What can I do with this major?

AREAS	EMPLOYERS	STRATEGIES
<u>MUSEUMS AND GALLERIES</u> Art direction Administration Curatorial Conservation Restoration Registrar Collections management Exhibit Design/Preparation Archive management Education Tours Sales Publications Development Public relations Historian	Art museums: University Public Private Archives Historical societies Natural history museums Living history museums Galleries Community centers Auction houses	Gain relevant experience through internships or volunteer positions in museums or galleries. Visit museums around the country and world to gain exposure to art. Learn a foreign language and plan to study abroad. Supplement curriculum with courses in history, religion, anthropology, and classical civilizations. Most art historians will specialize in a period or region. Acquire strong skills in research, fund-raising, speaking, writing, and an attention to detail. Plan to earn a graduate degree in art history, museum studies, or other related discipline depending on specific interests. Each specialty has varying qualifications and required training. Develop good interpersonal skills, including the ability to work well on teams. Become a member of local museums. Read published resources provided by the American Alliance of Museums (AAM).
<u>FINE ARTS AND CRAFT ARTS</u> Glass Ceramics Textiles Printmaking Multi-media Fibre Painting Sculpture	Self-employed Studios Living history museums and historical sites School and community programs Colleges and universities Commissions	Complete a Master of Fine Arts (MFA) to continue developing skills and to increase professional opportunities in art related fields. Consider whether you want to pursue art as a full-time job or as an avocational interest. Opportunities are limited for full-time work. Many artists hold other jobs to supplement their income. Participate in juried shows and exhibitions. Maintain an up-to-date physical and digital portfolio of your work. Gain additional skills and experience through an apprenticeship, internship, or volunteer position with a professional artist or organization.

AREAS

EMPLOYERS

STRATEGIES

FINE ARTS AND CRAFT ARTS cont.

Illustration
Film
Performance
Installation
Video

Secure a guild membership.
Learn to network and make contacts.
Build a reputation by circulating art work and developing a particular style.

COMMERCIAL ART

See also *"What Can I Do With a Major in Graphic Art?"*

Graphic art
Motion design
Web design
Graphic novels
Illustration
Story boards
Advertising
Medical and scientific illustration
Typography
Animation
Art direction
Logo/Branding
Design:
 Advertisement
 Magazine
 Layout
 Book
 Packaging
 Stationary
 Wallpaper

Advertising agencies
Public relation agencies
Design firms
Company marketing departments
Publishing companies:
 Magazines
 Newspapers
 Books
Department stores
Television and motion picture industry
Manufacturing firms
Greeting card companies
Internet media companies
Self-employed
Large corporations
Governmental agencies
Universities

Develop excellent technical and computer skills in a variety of platforms and design software.
Maintain an up-to-date physical and digital portfolio of your work.
Gain relevant experience through part-time jobs and internships.
Obtain summer or part-time experience with book, magazine, or newspaper publishers.
Develop attention to detail and ability to meet deadlines.
Supplement curriculum with course work in advertising or business.
For medical illustration, undergraduate coursework in anatomy and biology may be necessary, as well as a master's degree in medical illustration.
Participate in the Society of Illustrators Student Scholarship Competition to build a greater understanding of the industry and to gain recognition.

AREAS	EMPLOYERS	STRATEGIES
<u>EDUCATION</u> Formalized instruction Recreational instruction Research (Art history) Art curriculum writing	K-12 schools, public and private Universities and colleges Art schools Adult and community programs Museums Recreation centers Libraries Group homes Arts and Craft Centers (Arrowmont)	Develop strong communication skills and teaching ability through coursework and campus activities. Acquire a teaching certificate for public school teaching. Learn about requirements by state. Gain experience working with children through volunteer or part-time work. Participate in art clubs, juried shows, and exhibitions. Maintain an updated physical and digital portfolio of your work. To teach art history in higher education: Take general history classes in addition to art history classes. Learn one or more foreign language to research original sources. Earn a doctoral degree in art history. To teach studio and fine arts in higher education, earn a graduate degree in a specific area of art. Study, memorize, and analyze art movements around the world.

ART THERAPY

Art therapy is a mental health profession that utilizes the creative process of art to enhance functioning in individuals experiencing mental or physical difficulties. It combines the creation of art with theories of counseling and psychotherapy. (Adapted from AATA resources.)

Hospitals
Nursing homes
Mental health facilities
Rehabilitation centers
Nonprofit organizations
Community agencies and centers
Schools, colleges, and universities
Correctional facilities
Domestic violence and homeless shelters
Art studios
Private practice

Take courses in art, as well as courses in psychology, social work, education, or child and family studies.
A master's degree and coursework in art therapy from a program accredited by The American Art Therapy Association (AATA) is required to enter the field.
Volunteer in a rehabilitation setting.
Learn to work well with many types of people and develop excellent communication skills.
Cultivate a strong sense of empathy, patience, and interpersonal skills. Learn to work in a team environment.

AREAS	EMPLOYERS	STRATEGIES
<u>MEDIA</u> Journalism: Production Design Art criticism Editing Art direction Sales Programming Video Illustration Animation Story boards Film Social media Digital imaging and editing	Newspapers Magazines Websites Book publishers Studios	Develop excellent grammar and writing skills along with knowledge of the history and culture of art. Learn HTML and other computer programs to prepare for online work. This area of journalism is growing while print is declining. Become comfortable working in a deadline-oriented atmosphere. Work with campus or local newspapers. Create a portfolio of work samples, especially those that have been published. Seek opportunities for recognition and networking through writing contests and freelance writing submissions.
<u>PHOTOGRAPHY</u> Fine Arts News Commercial and industrial Portrait Nature Scientific Journalism Food Underwater Wedding/Events Fashion	Museums Newspapers Magazines Websites Photo agencies Studios Libraries Large corporations Self-employed Venues	Develop proficiency with photo editing software. Because more than half of all professional photographers are self-employed, it is important to develop knowledge and understanding of business principles. Apprentice with a free-lance photographer. Maintain an up-to-date portfolio of both black and white and color photography. Obtain an internship or part-time job with the campus newspaper, local newspaper, website or other media outlet.

AREAS	EMPLOYERS	STRATEGIES
<u>ART SALES</u>	Self-employed Dealers Galleries Museums Auction houses Specialty stores Art Consultants	Learn to communicate effectively with a wide range of people. Take additional courses in interpersonal communication and public speaking. Prepare to work independently and to be self-motivated. Plan to work irregular and/or long hours. Cultivate an entrepreneurial spirit, including self discipline and perseverance, these are keys to success. Pursue a business minor to increase knowledge of business principles Obtain sales experience through internships or summer and part-time jobs. Volunteer in museums, membership drives, local galleries, and community outreach programs. Serve as a student assistant in a university gallery. Develop solid public speaking skills. Become familiar with marketing techniques using social media platforms.
<u>FASHION AND TEXTILE DESIGN</u> Fashion design Fashion product development Entrepreneurship Colorists Stylists Fabric development Surface design Management Buying Tapestry 2D, 3D, and 4D product design	Fabric manufacturers, printers, and converters Print design studios Garment suppliers Retailers Fashion Houses	Most professionals in this field have formalized education and training in the field of fashion and textile design. Research schools offering related programs. Develop proficiency using industry specific computer software such as CAD systems and Adobe Photoshop and Illustrator. Display motivation by designing clothes for yourself and others. Stay up to date on fashion and design trends by following current media related to fashion and textile design. Be able to communicate effectively with different types of people in various functional areas. Expect to work with overseas suppliers. Knowledge of languages, customs, and cultures is helpful. Gain experience by completing internships with design or related firms.

GENERAL INFORMATION

- A bachelor's degree is valuable for entry-level positions, but an advanced degree is usually necessary to attain competitive, upper-level positions.
- An art degree can and should be tailored to areas of specialization.
- Save artwork for a strong portfolio - too much is better than too little.
- Be prepared to relocate to the larger markets of metropolitan areas where more opportunities exist.
- Join art-related professional and student organizations.
- Volunteer with fundraising efforts for the arts.
- Gain valuable experience through volunteering, private lessons, internships, part-time and summer jobs, and apprenticeships.
- Seek exposure to art by visiting museums around the country and world.
- Conduct informational interviews with professionals in areas of interest to learn more about opportunities and strategies for these areas. Learn to network.
- Pair an art degree with other career interests to increase opportunities and provide supplemental income.
- According to the Department of Labor, 55% of Artists are self-employed.
- Develop skills in business management, computers, marketing, and other related areas to increase marketability.
- Many artists advance by establishing a skill in a specific area. Focus on cultivating expertise in specialized design platforms.
- Visual display software is increasingly being used in visual arts. Incorporate computer training into your curriculum and/or experience.
- A career in the arts takes dedication, patience, flexibility, talent, and some luck.